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Earring, nose ring

10.5.1 Earring, nose ring

References:

Hebrew נֶזֶם (nezem) GEN 24:22, GEN 24:30, GEN 24:47, GEN 35:4, EXO 32:2, EXO 32:3, EXO 35:22, JDG 8:24, JDG 8:24, JDG 8:25, JDG 8:26, JOB 42:11, PRO 11:22, PRO 25:12, ISA 3:21, EZK 16:12, HOS 2:15

Hebrew עָגִיל (ʻagil) NUM 31:50, EZK 16:12

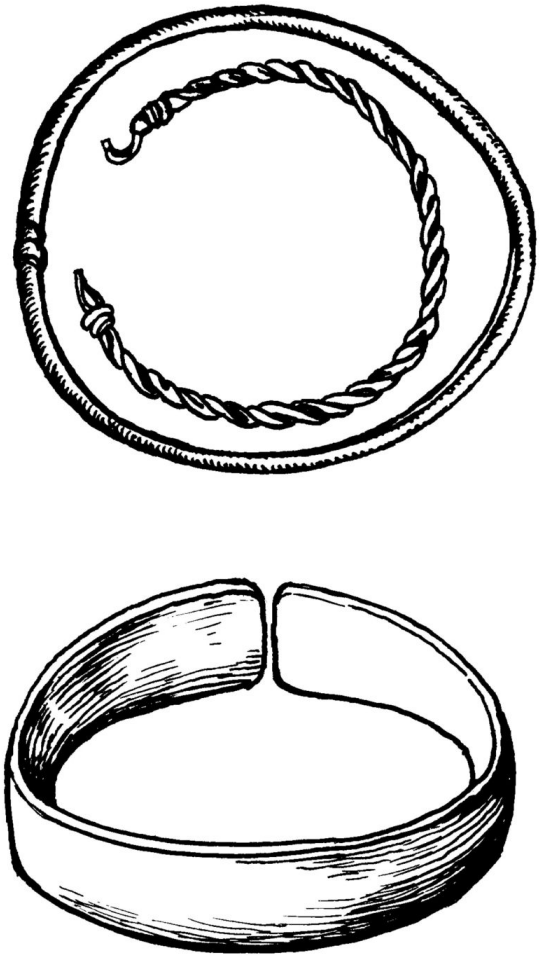
Greek ἐνώτιον (enōtion) JDT 10:4

Description and usage:

Gold earrings (Metropolitan Museum of Art, Public domain, MMA)The earring was worn on the ear and the nose ring in the nose for decoration. They were small rings, usually made of silver or gold. They could have more or less elaborate decorative work attached to them.

Translation:

The Hebrew word *nezem* refers to a ring that could be worn in the ear or in the nose. In either case, it was worn as decorative jewelry.



Nose rings (© Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, Stuttgart by United Bible Societies)The Hebrew word *ʻagil* in EZK 16:12 clearly refers to an earring, and this is probably the case in NUM 31:50 also.

(Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)The Greek word *enōtion* in JDT 10:4 specifically indicates a ring worn in the ear, not in the nose.